

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #2112

Name
Danielle Bartz
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Gender
Female
City, state, and country of residence
Pepeekeo, Hawaii, USA
Nationality
United States
When did or will you finish your PhD?
Spring 2024
University Education
August 2019-Current: PhD in Marine Biology, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, Specialization in Ecology, Evolution, and Conservation Biology (EECB) (Current GPA: 4.0)
May 2018: Bachelor of Science in Geoscience, Cum Laude; Minor in Biology, Biology Honors Distinction, Florida Atlantic University (GPA: 3.589)
May 2018: Advanced Certificate in Geographic Information Systems (GIS), Florida Atlantic University
May 2018: Certificate in Environmental Science, Florida Atlantic University
May 2014: Associate of Arts, Broward College (GPA: 3.353)
What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?
Becoming a fellow would allow me to expand on both my personal and professional goals at the same time. Professionally, I'm passionate about teaching science and working with local communities. This came as a bit of a surprise to me, because entering graduate school I never imagined that I'd actually enjoy teaching others. I dreaded having to become a Teaching Assistant but I knew it would pay my tuition. After my first semester of teaching, I admitted to myself that not only did I find teaching enjoyable and value the engagement aspect, but I was good at it. I ended up continuing teaching freshman biology labs for a total of 5 semesters, initially in person and eventually fully online due to COVID19. In that time, I was nominated for an Excellence in Teaching award

three years in a row, and had a number of students reach out to tell me how I made an impact on their academic careers. Personally, it has been my life goal to travel the world and emerge myself in different cultures. I have been enamored by the beauty and richness of Indian culture for years and plan to spend extended time there at some point.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

In addition to finding my passion for teaching during my time in grad school, I've also found my passion for working with local communities. I've become involved in citizen science through two of my recent research assistantships, in one working with local elementary school children to collect invasive fish out of streams for a growth study and the other training and providing equipment to local fishers to tag pelagic sharks. My dissertation research also allows me to work with the community by collecting the knowledge and observations of fishers to assess shifts in fish assemblages over time. From teaching, mentoring, serving as the graduate representative for my program and the president of multiple academic organizations as an undergraduate, in addition to former leadership training through the LeaderShape Institute, I have procured various qualities that make me an adept leader. These include compassion and active listening, fairness and equality, diversity promotion, sharing my passion and leading by example, and being regarded as "easy to talk to". I also possess the emotional intelligence to thrive when out of my comfort zone, which I gained from leaving my life behind and moving across an ocean to continue my education in an unfamiliar place.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

I imagine myself working in science education and outreach because I love teaching and working with local, indigenous, or underrepresented communities. In the near future, I imagine myself continuing to do this with the communities on Hawai'i Island, as I've been working hard to foster relationships built on respect and reciprocity and to identify community needs. However, my goal is to travel extensively post-graduation. Academia has always been my life and I've yearned to travel abroad and experience a plethora of foreign cultures and customs. I believe that there is so much to be learned outside of the traditional classroom and I've always possessed an open mind and adventurous spirit. My long term goal is to eventually open a marine biology field school in Costa Rica, where I can teach local school groups scientific methods, field techniques, survey skills, language, and even yoga and surfing to nurture mind-body connections. This would allow me to continue studying shark nursery habitats while also engaging with communities and sharing my knowledge and training for the greater good. I believe that the more children that are inspired to engage in science and conservation, the more hope there is for the future of humanity.

CV/Resume

 [BartzDanielle CV22 full.docx.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

University email list

Any other comments/questions?

My desired placement location is India, although I would happily take any. My desired date would be the beginning of 2024, although I can be somewhat flexible with timing. While I'm fully aware that many other applicants may supersede me in qualifications, publications, or career experience, I am fully committed to instilling a passion for science within others. I plan to teach and participate in science outreach abroad and will accomplish this one way or another. The Science Corps program would be the perfect foot-in-the-door I need to embark on a lifetime career of promoting science and education in foreign countries. Thank you for your consideration.

[Science Corps](#)